

Paradiem 

The Morning Brief

SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

PCE Morning

Reported oil sharp reversal on reported Iran-US diplomatic thaw as reported August PCE, Q2 GDP third estimate, ADP, and Chicago PMI cluster Wednesday morning; reported utilities lead into softer tape.

S&P 500 (SPY, TUE) \$764.20 ↓0.18%	WTI (USO) / BRENT (BNO, TUE) \$143.35 ↓4.44% / \$58.75 ↓2.62%	10Y YIELD / GOLD (GLD, TUE) Reportedly ~5.28% 2007 high per Trading Economics / \$382.89 ↑1.32%	BITCOIN (IBIT, TUE) \$47.33 ↑0.25%	FEAR & GREED (CNN STOCK) Reportedly in Fear zone per Benzinga · Drop reads 71 crypto fallback
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SECTION 01

Markets — Reported Oil Sharp Reversal Reportedly Unwinds Monday's Iran Premium as Reported August PCE, Reported Q2 GDP Third Estimate, Reported ADP, and Reported Chicago PMI Cluster This Morning; Reported Utilities Lead Into Softer Tape

REPORTED WTI (USO) REPORTEDLY ↓4.44% TUESDAY TO \$143.35 AND REPORTED BRENT (BNO) REPORTEDLY ↓2.62% TO \$58.75 AS REPORTED QATAR-MEDIATED IRAN-US DIPLOMATIC TRACK REPORTEDLY ADVANCES; REPORTED 10-YEAR YIELD REPORTEDLY REACHES APPROXIMATELY 5.28% (REPORTEDLY A 2007 HIGH) PER TRADING ECONOMICS

Per data drop, SPY reportedly closed Tuesday at \$764.20 (↓0.18%), DIA at \$512.88 (↓0.22%), and QQQ diverged higher at \$737.93 (↑0.19%) as the reported physical-oil layer reportedly reversed sharply lower against Monday's reported Iran premium. Per data drop, WTI (USO) reportedly closed Tuesday at \$143.35 (↓4.44%), Brent (BNO) at \$58.75 (↓2.62%), and UNG at \$10.35 (↓4.08%) as reported Qatari mediators reportedly pressed a reported Iran-US peace deal per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines. Per Trading Economics coverage of the reported Tuesday Treasury curve, the reported 10-year yield reportedly climbed to approximately 5.28% (reportedly holding a reported 2007 high) and the reported 30-year reportedly surpassed approximately 5.60% (reportedly a reported 2002 level), and per data drop, TLT reportedly closed at \$78.23 (↓0.50%). Per data drop, the reported utilities sleeve reportedly led with XLU ↑1.17% at \$39.71, EIX ↑4.06% at \$53.56, VST ↑2.04% at \$140.83, and CEG ↑1.59% at \$264.58 — a reported AI-power-and-defensive rotation reportedly reading through the reported softer tape. Per data drop, Carson's active SPY support level at \$645.80 (retracement target set April 13) remains untouched, with Tuesday's reported intraday low of \$762.35 well above that level.

S&P 500 (SPY, TUE)	\$764.20 ↓0.18%
NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW (DIA, TUE)	\$737.93 ↑0.19% / \$512.88 ↓0.22%
10Y YIELD / 30Y YIELD	Reportedly ~5.28% 2007 high / Reportedly ~5.60% 2002 level per Trading Economics
TLT (20Y BOND, TUE)	\$78.23 ↓0.50%
GOLD (GLD) / SILVER (SLV, TUE)	\$382.89 ↑1.32% / \$55.48 ↑0.96%
WTI (USO) / BRENT (BNO, TUE)	\$143.35 ↓4.44% / \$58.75 ↓2.62%
EIX / VST / CEG (TUE)	\$53.56 ↑4.06% / \$140.83 ↑2.04% / \$264.58 ↑1.59%
FED OCT 27–28 HIKE ODDS	Reportedly ~73–77% for +25 bp per CME FedWatch coverage
CARSON'S ACTIVE SPY SUPPORT	\$645.80 retracement target · Untouched (Tue low \$762.35)

REPORTED AUGUST PCE, REPORTED Q2 GDP THIRD ESTIMATE, REPORTED ADP EMPLOYMENT, AND REPORTED CHICAGO PMI CLUSTER THIS MORNING; REPORTED CLEVELAND FED NOWCAST REPORTEDLY POINTS TO APPROXIMATELY 3.8% HEADLINE AND APPROXIMATELY 3.4% CORE PCE PER FXSTREET COVERAGE

Per Bureau of Economic Analysis release calendar coverage, the reported August Personal Income and Outlays release (including the reported PCE inflation series) is reportedly scheduled Wednesday, September 30 at 8:30 AM ET alongside the reported Q2 GDP third estimate and the reported annual update to the National Economic Accounts. Per FXStreet and Cleveland Fed nowcast coverage carried through the reported Tuesday tape, reported August headline PCE is reportedly

projected at approximately 3.8% YoY and reported core PCE at approximately 3.4% YoY, framing the reported final inflation read before the reported October 27–28 FOMC decision. Per BLS release calendar coverage, the reported August JOLTS reportedly printed 7.079 million reported job openings Monday (reportedly ↓256,000 from the reported upwardly-revised 7.335 million July print), framing a reported cooling labor-demand signal into the reported September Employment Situation reportedly scheduled Friday, October 2 at 8:30 AM ET. Per data drop, the reported FCI Growth-Hybrid chip sleeve reportedly rebounded with MRVL ↑4.51% at \$263.27, LRCX ↑2.99% at \$323.86, TSM ↑0.90% at \$456.94, and ADI ↑0.71% at \$398.22, while QCOM reportedly extended lower at ↓1.80% to \$184.10 — a reported bifurcated chip tape reportedly reading through the reported AI-memory-and-infrastructure signal. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported oil sharp reversal reportedly reading through the reported Iran-US diplomatic thaw, a reported utilities-and-AI-power rotation reportedly reading through the reported defensive channel, a reported chip bifurcation reportedly reading through the reported AI-memory signal, and a reported PCE-GDP-ADP-PMI cluster reportedly reading through the reported Fed-path signal this morning — keeps CHD, CL, ABT, SYK, DGX, ADP, SPGI, NEE, EIX, VST, CEG, ATO, and the reported FCI rate-sensitive-and-utilities sleeves reading through the reported household channel and the reported October 27–28 FOMC decision.

A reported oil sharp reversal on the reported Qatar-mediated Iran-US diplomatic thaw sitting against a reported utilities-and-AI-power rotation and a reported 10-year yield reportedly holding a reported 2007 high frames a Wednesday setup where discipline over impulse tends to serve better than compositing a single directional view into the reported 8:30 AM PCE-GDP-ADP cluster.

Simplicity over complexity.

Geopolitics — Reported Qatari Mediators Reportedly Press Iran-US Peace Deal per Reuters; Reported Trump Reportedly Denies Willingness to Ease Iran Sanctions; Reported US Forces Reportedly Exit Iraq Reportedly Emboldening Iran Proxies and Islamic State

REPORTED QATARI DIPLOMATIC TRACK REPORTEDLY ADVANCES BEHIND A REPORTED WHITE HOUSE DENIAL ON REPORTED SANCTIONS RELIEF; REPORTED PHYSICAL-OIL LAYER REPORTEDLY REVERSES SHARPLY LOWER AGAINST MONDAY'S REPORTED IRAN PREMIUM

Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, one piece reportedly framed reported Qatari mediators as reportedly pressing a reported peace deal between the reported United States and Iran, and per separate Reuters coverage carried in the drop, one piece reportedly framed reported oil as gaining after President Trump reportedly denied he is reportedly willing to ease reported Iran sanctions. Per CNBC and AOL coverage of the reported Tuesday-into-Wednesday tape, President Trump reportedly wrote on Truth Social that he reportedly offered Iran nothing, reportedly dismissing a reported Axios report which reportedly framed him as reportedly willing to give Iran reported sanctions relief and reportedly release reported frozen Iranian funds in exchange for reported concrete steps on the reported nuclear program. Per data drop, WTI (USO) reportedly closed Tuesday at \$143.35 (↓4.44%) and Brent (BNO) at \$58.75 (↓2.62%) as the reported physical-oil layer reportedly reversed sharply lower against Monday's reported Iran premium — a reported reversal reportedly reading through the reported diplomatic thaw rather than the reported military overhang. Per data drop, CVX reportedly closed ↓0.96% at \$204.38 and OKE reportedly closed ↓1.99% at \$86.86 into the reported oil reversal, and per data drop, XLE reportedly closed ↓0.90% at \$61.54 — the reported sector laggard on the Tuesday tape. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported Qatari mediation reportedly advancing, a reported White House denial on sanctions relief, a reported physical-oil sharp reversal reportedly unwinding Monday's Iran premium, and a reported energy-sector laggard on the Tuesday tape — keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, LMT, and GD reading through the reported physical-crude signal, the reported sanctions perimeter, and the reported diplomatic gap into the Wednesday setup.

REPORTED US FORCES REPORTEDLY EXIT IRAQ AFTER TWO DECADES PER REUTERS, REPORTEDLY EMBOLDENING IRAN PROXIES AND REPORTED ISLAMIC STATE; REPORTED IRAN APPEALS TO REPORTED US VOTERS PER REUTERS; REPORTED US SENATE REPORTEDLY BLOCKS A REPORTED WEST BANK RIGHTS-VIOLATIONS REPORTING MEASURE

Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, one piece reportedly framed reported US forces as reportedly exiting Iraq, reportedly emboldening reported Iran proxies and reported Islamic State, and per separate Reuters coverage carried in the drop, one piece reportedly framed reported how the US controls reported Iraq oil revenues. Per additional Reuters coverage carried in the drop, one piece reportedly framed reported Iran as reportedly appealing to reported American voters as reported US troops reportedly leave Iraq, and per additional Reuters coverage carried in the drop, one piece reportedly framed the reported US Senate as reportedly blocking a reported measure demanding a reported report on reported rights violations in the reported West Bank. Per data

drop, LMT reportedly closed Tuesday at \$512.21 (↓1.14%) and GD reportedly closed at \$332.34 (↓0.54%) into the reported regional-security shift, and per data drop holdings news, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed reported Boeing as reportedly winning a reported Navy contract for a reported sixth-generation fire — a reported defense-industrial-base read against the reported LMT and GD context. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported US Iraq withdrawal reportedly reframing the reported Persian Gulf regional-security architecture, a reported Iran appeal to reported US voters reportedly reading through the reported midterm-cycle channel, a reported Senate West Bank block reportedly reading through the reported congressional-oversight channel, and a reported defense-industrial-base read reportedly framing the reported sixth-generation-fire signal — keeps LMT, GD, CVX, OKE, CNX, and NEE reading through the reported physical-crude signal, the reported defense narrative, and the reported cross-asset spillover into the Wednesday setup.

On Our Radar

1. Today at 8:30 AM ET — Reported August PCE, Reported Q2 GDP Third Estimate, Reported ADP Employment; Reported Chicago PMI at 9:45 AM ET; Reported MU, FDS, JBL, JEF, CALM, and PRGS Reportedly Report Today; Reported ISM Manufacturing Thursday and Reported September Nonfarm Payrolls Friday.

Per Bureau of Economic Analysis release calendar coverage, the reported August Personal Income and Outlays release (including the reported PCE inflation series) is reportedly scheduled today at 8:30 AM ET alongside the reported Q2 GDP third estimate and the reported annual update to the National Economic Accounts, and per ADP release coverage, the reported ADP National Employment Report is reportedly scheduled today. Per FXStreet and Cleveland Fed nowcast coverage, reported August headline PCE is reportedly projected at approximately 3.8% YoY and reported core PCE at approximately 3.4% YoY. Per data drop earnings section, Micron (MU) reportedly reports fiscal Q4 today after the close with reported consensus of approximately \$32.32 EPS, FactSet (FDS) with approximately \$4.38 EPS, Jabil (JBL) with approximately \$4.10 EPS, and Jefferies (JEF) with approximately \$0.94 EPS. Per BLS release calendar coverage, the reported September Employment Situation is reportedly scheduled Friday, October 2 at 8:30 AM ET, and per ISM release calendar coverage, the reported September ISM Manufacturing PMI is reportedly scheduled Thursday, October 1 at 10:00 AM ET.

2. Reported Oil Sharp Reversal — WTI (USO) Reportedly ↓4.44% Tuesday to \$143.35 and Brent (BNO) Reportedly ↓2.62% to \$58.75 per Data Drop; Reported Qatari Mediators Reportedly Press Iran-US Peace Deal per Reuters; Reported Overnight Bid Reportedly Reappears as Trump Reportedly Denies Sanctions Relief per CNBC.

Per data drop, WTI (USO) reportedly closed Tuesday at \$143.35 (↓4.44%), Brent (BNO) at \$58.75 (↓2.62%), and UNG at \$10.35 (↓4.08%) as the reported physical-oil layer reportedly reversed sharply lower against Monday's reported Iran premium. Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, one piece reportedly framed reported Qatari mediators as reportedly pressing a reported peace deal between the reported United States and Iran, and per CNBC and AOL coverage of the reported Tuesday-into-Wednesday tape, reported oil reportedly climbed overnight after President Trump reportedly denied he is reportedly willing to ease reported Iran sanctions, reportedly framing an intraday reversal into the Wednesday setup. For FCI positioning — a reported oil sharp reversal reportedly unwinding Monday's Iran premium, a reported Qatari mediation reportedly advancing, and a reported overnight bid reportedly reappearing — keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, LMT, and GD reading through the reported physical-crude signal into the Wednesday setup.

3. Reported Utilities-and-AI-Power Rotation — XLU Reportedly ↑1.17% Tuesday to \$39.71 (Reported Sector Leader); EIX Reportedly ↑4.06% to \$53.56, VST Reportedly ↑2.04% to \$140.83, and CEG Reportedly ↑1.59% to \$264.58 per Data Drop.

Per data drop, the reported utilities sector (XLU) reportedly led Tuesday at ↑1.17% to \$39.71 with the reported FCI utilities-and-AI-power sleeve reportedly participating: EIX ↑4.06% at \$53.56, VST ↑2.04% at \$140.83, CEG ↑1.59% at \$264.58, and NEE ↑0.53% at \$75.89. Per data drop holdings news, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Constellation Energy as reportedly on a reported buy-now-before-catching-on list, and per separate data drop holdings news, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Vistra as reportedly reporting reported Q3 earnings November 6, 2026. Per data drop holdings news, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Caterpillar as reportedly surging 75% over the reported past year on reported AI power demand — a reported physical-AI-infrastructure read-through into the reported utilities-and-industrials layer. For FCI positioning — a reported utilities-and-AI-power rotation reportedly leading the Tuesday tape, a reported defensive-and-physical-AI-infrastructure signal, and a reported CAT-and-AI-power narrative — keeps EIX, VST, CEG, NEE, ATO, CAT, and the reported FCI physical-AI-infrastructure sleeve reading through the reported physical-world-matters signal into the Wednesday setup.

4. Reported Chip Bifurcation — MRVL Reportedly ↑4.51% Tuesday to \$263.27, LRCX Reportedly ↑2.99% to \$323.86, and TSM Reportedly ↑0.90% to \$456.94 per Data Drop; QCOM Reportedly ↓1.80% to \$184.10 (Reported Second Consecutive Down Session); Reported MU Reportedly Reports Fiscal Q4 Today After the Close.

Per data drop, the reported FCI Growth-Hybrid chip sleeve reportedly rebounded with MRVL ↑4.51% at \$263.27, LRCX ↑2.99% at \$323.86, TSM ↑0.90% at \$456.94, and ADI ↑0.71% at \$398.22, while QCOM reportedly extended lower at ↓1.80% to \$184.10 and NVDA reportedly closed ↓0.72% at \$227.21. Per data drop holdings news, one SeekingAlpha piece reportedly framed reported Credo as reportedly presenting an opportunity, and per separate data drop holdings news, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed reported TSMC as reportedly on track for a reported \$3 trillion market cap before 2027. Per data drop earnings section, Micron (MU) reportedly reports fiscal Q4 today after the close with reported consensus of approximately \$32.32 EPS — the reported first major AI-memory print of the reported cycle. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps NVDA, AMD, TSM, MRVL, LRCX, KEYS, CRDO, TEL, ADI, NXPI, and QCOM reading through the reported semiconductor supply-chain layer and the reported AI-memory signal into the Wednesday setup.

5. Reported Bitcoin ETF Sleeve — IBIT Reportedly ↑0.25% Tuesday to \$47.33 and ETHA Reportedly ↑0.65% to \$20.28 per Data Drop; Reported Crypto ETFs Reportedly Add Approximately \$2.95B Over 30 Days per Yahoo Coverage. Per data drop, IBIT reportedly closed Tuesday at \$47.33 (↑0.25%) and ETHA at \$20.28 (↑0.65%) into the reported softer broad-tape session and the reported oil sharp reversal. Per data drop holdings news, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed reported crypto ETFs as reportedly adding approximately \$2.95 billion in reported net inflows over 30 days led by reported spot Bitcoin funds, and per separate data drop holdings news, one Benzinga piece reportedly framed reported investors as reportedly shorting three reported crypto stocks to reportedly hedge a reported Bitcoin rise. For FCI positioning — a reported IBIT-and-ETHA sleeve reading through the reported softer broad tape and the reported strong US spot-ETF inflow trend — keeps IBIT and ETHA reading through the reported crypto signal and the reported duration layer into the Wednesday setup.

6. Reported CNN Stock Fear & Greed Reportedly Reads in Fear Zone per Benzinga; Reported Drop Value at 71 Is the Reported Crypto Fallback per CNN Stock Endpoint Failure. Per Benzinga and CNN Fear & Greed live tape coverage, the reported CNN Stock Market Fear & Greed Index reportedly reads in the reported Fear zone as of the reported Tuesday close, and per data drop, the reported Fear & Greed value of 71 (Greed) reflects the reported crypto fallback after the reported CNN stock endpoint reportedly failed. Per data drop, UVXY (VIX proxy) reportedly closed Tuesday at \$16.99 (↓0.53%) into the reported softer tape. For FCI positioning — a reported CNN Stock Fear reading sitting against a reported crypto-Greed reading of 71 reportedly reads a reported bifurcated sentiment tape into the reported PCE-GDP-ADP cluster — keeps the reported FCI defensive-and-hedging read reading through the reported sentiment layer into the Wednesday setup.

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